

If you have enough conviction in your own way of doing things, and you feel steady and confident in your priorities, you'll feel better equipped to differentiate between good, helpful advice and somebody who may be applying their own belief system to your life, in a way that doesn't serve you.

Much of this is to do with having the right boundaries in place, which is something that we will talk about a little bit later, but while we're in this stage of understanding and making peace with your mistakes, try to remove any judgement or disappointment that you've experienced from the equation as you start to forgive yourself.

Self-forgiveness in practice

It's all very well acknowledging that we need to forgive ourselves for financial mistakes in order to move on from them, but I know better than most that it's easier said than done. When you're in the habit of dwelling on mistakes, and of tying every bit of unhappiness in your life now to a mistake that you made in the past, that place of genuine self-forgiveness might feel completely out of reach. There is also the fact that sometimes, when we make poor decisions with money, it has a knock-on effect on other people that we care about, and the guilt associated with that can be very valid. We'll talk about how to address that guilt and make amends, because it's an important part of moving on from your mistakes, but for now, let's focus on forgiving yourself.